

Outlook

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Follow-up: what is underneath the headline growth?

Morning,

I need help with something that sounds simple but probably is not.

The headline activity story is positive, but EXCO cannot tell whether it reflects durable customer relationships or short-lived transaction volume. Failure anecdotes are beginning to drive decisions, although retries and late posting may be making the problem look larger than the affected-customer population.

The questions I would ask in the room are:

1. What would we expect to see if activity is concentrated in a small set of customers?
2. What evidence would instead support that service failures are creating volume without creating value?
3. How do we rule out that new accounts are becoming primary relationships?

This has returned because the previous answer was useful but not strong enough to become a standing rule. Use March 2023 as the new evidence point rather than recycling the earlier conclusion. Please work towards where to invest and which headline measure should be retired from the management pack. A useful output would be a Power BI page with drill-through to a reproducible case list.

Use monthly account snapshots, status events, limits, product enrolments and signatories; transaction-level timestamps, channels, amounts, statuses and error context; customer contacts, complaints and suggestions; campaign design and customer responses. One caution: Do not describe account activity as profitability; the data does not contain a full revenue and cost allocation.

Regards